

How to Run Linux on a Windows Machine

Kipling once said, "Oh, East is East and West is West, and never the twain shall meet ..." This same sentiment was often echoed about Linux and Windows. However, today, Linux can run on a Windows machine. This article discusses the several ways in which this is possible.

When you meet any Windows user and talk about using Linux, the first thing you will probably hear is, "I cannot use Linux because I don't know the commands and I am not a computer guru." The fact, however, is that today's top Linux desktop distributions such as Mint, openSUSE and Ubuntu are much easier to use than Windows 8.

Can Linux be run on Windows?

Another misconception among people who want to use Linux but are still on Windows is that the only way to use Linux and Windows on the same hardware is by making it dual boot. And they feel that with Windows 8 bringing in secure boot, a dual boot could turn into a nightmare.

But the truth is that it is not only possible but also very easy to start using Linux on a running Windows system, and there are many options for doing this.

Ways to use Linux on Windows

Let's look at the various options available to run Linux on Windows that we will be discussing in this article.

1. Take the online Ubuntu tour
2. Try Linux CLI on the Web browser
3. Try Linux-like Windows software
4. Try Linux with a live CD
5. Try Linux using a pen drive
6. Try Linux using a virtual machine
7. Try coLinux based distributions

Now let's start discuss each option in detail.

Take the online Ubuntu tour

This should be one of the easiest ways to try your hand at Linux. Ubuntu offers a Web application that simulates an installed Ubuntu desktop in your Web browser. Just open any Web browser and go to [http://](http://tour.ubuntu.com/en/)

tour.ubuntu.com/en/ and start exploring the Ubuntu desktop version. This gives an interactive view of the Ubuntu desktop, where the user can experience various Ubuntu menu options.

Try Linux CLI on a Web browser

The earlier option allows you to experience the Ubuntu GUI. But if you want to try Linux in its original form, i.e., CLI, open any browser from Windows, go to <http://bellard.org/jslinux/index.html> and start trying out Linux CLI. This is a JavaScript based emulator which lets you run various Linux commands. You can write shell scripts, use regular expression utilities like SED and AWK, experience editors like Vi and Emacs, and can also look up the man pages.

Try Linux-like Windows software

Wouldn't it be nice if we could install Linux on a Windows machine just as we install any other software in Windows? Well, let's take a look at WUBI.

